

Claire R. McNellan, Ph.D., M.P.H.

[Email](#) | [Website](#) | [Google Scholar](#)

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENT

2024- **Assistant Professor**, Colorado School of Public Health
Department of Health Systems, Management and Policy
University of Colorado Anschutz Medical Campus

EDUCATION

2024 **Ph.D.**, University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill
Social Work
2017 **M.P.H.**, University of Washington
Global Health: Health Metrics and Evaluation
2014 **B.A.**, Colorado College
Neuroscience (*with distinction*), Minor: Bioethics

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Child- & family-serving systems; child maltreatment; injury and violence epidemiology; population health; system decision-making; social policy; public health surveillance.

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

22. McNellan, C. R., Richards, R.,* Johnson, E.,* Ingalls, M.,* Tailer, S.,* Putnam-Hornstein, E. The relationship between receipt of childcare subsidies and child protective services involvement in Douglas County, Colorado: A brief research report. (*Forthcoming in Journal of the Society for Social Work and Research*)
* Agency partner
21. Gibbs, D. J., Lanier, P., McNellan, C. R., Bryan, K., Identifying children at risk for maltreatment fatalities: Assessing the current landscape of birth match policies in the United States. *Journal of Public Child Welfare*. <https://doi.org/10.1080/15548732.2024.2319732>
20. Fullman, N., et al. [including McNellan, C.R.] (2023) Assessing the impact of community-based interventions on hypertension and diabetes management in three Minnesota communities: Findings from the prospective evaluation of US HealthRise programs. *PLoS ONE*, 18(2). <https://doi-org.libproxy.lib.unc.edu/10.1371/journal.pone.0279230>
19. McNellan, C. R., Gibbs, D. J., Knobel, A. S., & Putnam-Hornstein, E. (2022) The evidence base for risk assessment tools used in U.S. child protection investigations: A systematic scoping review. *Child Abuse and Neglect*, 134. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.chiabu.2022.105887>

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18. Foust, R., et al. [including **McNellan, C. R.**] (2022) The Children's Data Network: Harnessing the scientific potential of linked, administrative data to inform children's programs and policies. *International Journal of Population Data Science*, 6(3).
<https://doi.org/10.23889/ijpds.v6i3.1702>
17. Flor, L. S., et al. [including **McNellan, C. R.**] (2020) Community-based interventions for detection and management of diabetes and hypertension in underserved communities: A mixed-methods evaluation in Brazil, India, South Africa and the USA. *BMJ Global Health*, 5(6). <https://doi.org/10.1136/bmjgh-2019-001959>
16. **McNellan, C. R.**, Dansereau, E., Wallace, M. C., et al. (2019) Antenatal care as a means to increase participation in the continuum of maternal and child healthcare: An analysis of the poorest regions of four Mesoamerican countries. *BMC Pregnancy and Childbirth*, 19(1). <https://doi.org/10.1186/s12884-019-2207-9>
15. Duber, H. C., **McNellan, C. R.**, Wollum, A., et al. (2018) Public knowledge of cardiovascular disease and response to acute cardiac events in three cities in China and India. *Heart*, 104(1). <https://doi.org/10.1136/heartjnl-2017-311388>
14. Mokdad, A. H., et al. [including **McNellan, C. R.**] (2018) Supply-side interventions to improve health: Findings from the Salud Mesoamerica Initiative. *Plos One*, 13(4).
<https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0195292>
13. Wollum, A., Gabert, R., **McNellan, C. R.**, et al. (2018) Identifying gaps in the continuum of care for cardiovascular disease and diabetes in two communities in South Africa: Baseline findings from the HealthRise project. *Plos One*, 13(3).
<https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0192603>
12. El Bcheraoui, C., Zuniga-Brenes, P., Rios-Zertuche, D., Palmisano, E. B., **McNellan, C. R.**, et al. (2018) Health systems strategies to increase HIV screening among pregnant women in Mesoamerica. *Population Health Metrics*, 16(5). <https://doi.org/10.1186/s12963-018-0162-8>
11. Vos, T., et al. [including **McNellan, C. R.**] (2017) Global, regional, and national incidence, prevalence, and years lived with disability for 328 diseases and injuries for 195 countries, 1990–2016: A systematic analysis for the Global Burden of Disease Study 2016. *The Lancet*, 390, 1211-1259. [https://doi.org/10.1016/S0140-6736\(17\)32154-2](https://doi.org/10.1016/S0140-6736(17)32154-2)
10. Gabert, R., Ng, M., Sogarwal, R., Bryant, M., Deepu, R. V., **McNellan, C. R.**, et al. (2017) Identifying gaps in the continuum of care for hypertension and diabetes in two Indian communities. *BMC Health Services Research*, 17(846). <https://doi.org/10.1186/s12913-017-2796-9>

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9. Hernandez, B., et al. [including **McNellan, C. R.**] (2017) Barriers and facilitators for institutional delivery among poor Mesoamerican women: a cross-sectional study. *Health Policy and Planning*, 32(6), 769-780. <https://doi.org/10.1093/heapol/czx010>
7. Barber, R. M., et al. [including **McNellan, C. R.**] (2017) Healthcare access and quality index based on mortality from causes amenable to personal health care in 195 countries and territories, 1990-2015: A novel analysis from the global burden of disease study 2015. *The Lancet*, 390, 231-266. [https://doi.org/10.1016/S0140-6736\(17\)30818-8](https://doi.org/10.1016/S0140-6736(17)30818-8)
6. Lim, S. S., et al. [including **McNellan, C. R.**] (2016) Measuring the health-related Sustainable Development Goals in 188 countries: A baseline analysis from the Global Burden of Disease Study 2015. *The Lancet*, 388, 1813-1850. [https://doi.org/10.1016/S0140-6736\(16\)31467-2](https://doi.org/10.1016/S0140-6736(16)31467-2)
5. Kulikoff, X. R., et al. [including **McNellan, C. R.**] (2016) Health metrics priorities in the SDG era and beyond: a perspective from young researchers. *The Lancet*, 388: 2353-2354. [http://dx.doi.org/10.1016/S0140-6736\(16\)32134-1](http://dx.doi.org/10.1016/S0140-6736(16)32134-1)
4. Dansereau, E., **McNellan, C. R.**, Gagnier, M. C., et al. (2016) Coverage and timing of antenatal care among poor women in 6 Mesoamerican countries. *BMC Pregnancy and Childbirth*, 16(1). <https://doi.org/10.1186/s12884-016-1018-5>
3. Colombara, D.V., et al. [including **McNellan, C. R.**] (2016) Institutional delivery and satisfaction among Indigenous and poor women in Guatemala, Mexico, and Panama. *PLOS ONE*, 11(4), e154388. <https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0154388>
2. Colombara, D. V., Hernandez, B., **McNellan, C. R.**, et al. (2016) Diarrhea prevalence, care, and risk factors among poor children under 5 years of age in Mesoamerica. *American Journal of Tropical Medicine and Hygiene*, 94(3), 544-552. <https://doi.org/10.4269/ajtmh.15-0750>
1. Colombara, D. V., Hernandez, B., Gagnier, M. C., Johannis, C., Desai, S. S., Haakenstad, A., **McNellan, C. R.**, et al. (2015) Breastfeeding practices among poor women in Mesoamerica. *Journal of Nutrition*, 145(8), 1958-1965. <https://doi.org/10.3945/jn.115.213736>

MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW

3. **McNellan, C. R.**, Prindle, J., & Eastman, A. L, Putnam-Hornstein, E. Mortality in a California cohort of emerging adults exiting foster care. (*Revise & Resubmit*)
2. Sattler, K., **McNellan, C. R.**, Foust, R. Learning loss during the COVID-19 pandemic: Evidence from California.

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1. Flor, L. S., et al. [including **McNellan, C.R.**] Endline assessment of community-based program on hypertension and diabetes management in Brazil. Preprint available at medRxiv: <https://doi.org/10.1101/2022.05.22.22275385>

WORKING PAPERS

7. **McNellan, C.R.** et al., Using unsupervised machine learning to advance understanding of child maltreatment substantiation.
6. **McNellan, C.R.** et al., An empirical examination of organizational theories of maltreatment substantiation decisions made by a county-administered child protection system.
5. **McNellan, C.R.**, Palmer, L., McCroskey, J., Prindle, J. Disparities in community service referrals following an inconclusive or screened out child protection investigation.
4. Chen, W.-T., Huang, P.-Y., **McNellan, C. R.**, Vaithianathan, R., & Putnam-Hornstein, E. Child maltreatment registry policy change and allegation types in California: A difference-in-difference analysis.
2. Ahn, E., **McNellan, C.R.**, Prindle, J., Foust, R., Sattler, K., Putnam-Hornstein, E. Educational disparities among California children who experienced childhood maltreatment.
1. Gibbs, D. J., **McNellan, C. R.**, Dawes, H., & Forte, A. Outcomes associated with child participation in United States dependency court proceedings: A systematic review.

WHITE PAPERS & REPORTS

3. Putnam-Hornstein, E., Vaithianathan, R., McCroskey, J., Webster, D. [Data & Implementation Support: **McNellan, C.R.**] (2022) Los Angeles County Risk Stratification Model: Methodology and Implementation Report (Model Version 1.0). Children's Data Network. <https://dcfs.lacounty.gov/resources/reports/>
2. National Court Appointed Special Advocates/Guardians ad Litem Association For Children. [Impact estimates & outcomes: **McNellan, C.R.**] (2019) Change a Child's Story: 2019 Annual Report. <https://nationalcasagal.org/about-us/reports/national-casa-gal-association-for-children-2019-annual-report/>
1. National Court Appointed Special Advocates/Guardians ad Litem Association For Children. [Impact estimates & outcomes: **McNellan, C.R.**] (2018) Building a Better Future: 2018 Annual Report. <https://nationalcasagal.org/about-us/reports/national-casa-gal-association-for-children-2018-annual-report/>

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GRANTS & RESEARCH SUPPORT

- 2024- **Co-Investigator** (PI: Lindsey Palmer, PhD)
University of Utah
If we build it, will they come? An evaluation of uptake and engagement in alternatives to Child Protective Services
- 2024 **Research Coordinator**
Morgridge Family Foundation
Pilot: Colorado Implementation Science Unit (CISU)
Colorado Office of Children, Youth and Families
- 2022-2024 **Research Assistant** (PI: Emily Putnam-Hornstein, PhD)
Conrad N. Hilton Foundation
Risk Stratification Pilot: Data and Implementation
Subaward (\$600,000)
- 2021-2022 **Lead Investigator** (Faculty PI: Emily Putnam-Hornstein, PhD)
Douglas County Department of Human Services
A Retrospective Population-Based Study of Child Protective System Involvement
Research Contract (\$40,000)
- 2021-2023 **Principal Investigator** (Faculty Co-I: Emily Putnam-Hornstein, PhD)
Center for Innovation in Child Maltreatment Policy, Research, & Training at
Washington University in St. Louis
Assessing the Utility of a Risk-Stratification Model to Increase Equitable Service Connection
Pilot Project Award (\$20,000)
- 2020-2022 **Research Assistant** (Site PI: Emily Putnam-Hornstein, PhD)
Eunice Kennedy Shriver National Institute of Child Health and Human
Development (NICHD) 1P50HD096719-01
Project Data SMART (Selection, Management, Analysis, Replication & Transfer)
Subaward (\$247,500)
- 2020 **Research Assistant** (PI: Patricia Pavlinac, PhD)
National Institutes of Health (NIH) R01-AI150978-01
The Role of Enteric Pathogens and Antimicrobial Resistance in Driving Clinical and Nutritional Deterioration, and Azithromycin's Potential Effect, Among Children Discharged from Hospital in Kenya
(\$782,247)

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2014 **Principal Investigator**
Keller Family Venture Grant
Studying the “Father of Modern Neuroscience,” Santiago Ramón y Cajal, in-situ at neuroscience research center, Instituto Cajal, and throughout Spain (\$3,000)

HONORS & FELLOWSHIPS

2023 **Comprehensive oral substantive examination passed with distinction**
University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill School of Social Work

2022 **Fulbright student program semi-finalist**
U.S. Department of State

2022 **Comprehensive methods examination passed with distinction**
University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill School of Social Work

2021-2022 **Injury and Violence Prevention fellowship**
University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill Injury Prevention Research Center

2021 **Most outstanding student presentation**
University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill Injury Prevention Research Center conference, “Intersectional Approaches to Injury and Violence Prevention in a Post-COVID World”

2014-2017 **Post-Bachelor fellowship**
Institute for Health Metrics and Evaluation

2014 **Distinction in the major of neuroscience**
The Colorado College

2014- **Psi Chi International Honors Society**

2011- **Alpha Lambda Delta National Honors Society**

2010-2014 **Women’s Educational Society Scholarship**
The Colorado College

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS (* = presenting author)

2025 **McNellan, C.R.*** When Is Maltreatment Confirmed? Using Unsupervised Machine Learning to Advance Understanding of Child Protective Services Decisions. Part of a symposium: Chen, W.-T.*, Ahn, E.*, **McNellan, C.R.*** (Discussant: Palmer, L.) Exploring Decision-Making at the Front-End of the Child Protection System. *Seattle, WA.* [Accepted]

2024 Putnam-Hornstein, E.*, **McNellan, C.R.**, Prindle, J. Using Vital Death Records to Validate a Child Protection Risk Algorithm. Society for the Advancement of Violence and Injury Research (SAVIR) Annual Conference. *Chapel Hill, NC.*

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McNellan, C.R.* When is Maltreatment Confirmed? Using Unsupervised Machine Learning to Advance Understanding of Child Protective Services Decisions. Population Association of America (PAA) Annual Meeting. *Columbus, OH*.

2023

McNellan, C.R.*, Ahn, E.*, Noll, J.*, Miyamoto, S.* Symposium: Community-Based Services for the Prevention and Detection of Child Abuse and Neglect. The International Society for the Prevention of Child Abuse & Neglect (ISPCAN) International Congress. *Edinburgh, United Kingdom*.

McNellan, C.R., Putnam-Hornstein, E. (Poster) Using a Multi-State Markov Model to Estimate Mortality Risk Among Foster Youth During Transition. Population Association of America (PAA) Annual Meeting. *New Orleans, LA*.

McNellan, C.R.*, Gibbs, D., Putnam-Hornstein, E., Knobel, A. The Evidence for Risk Assessment Tools Used in Child Protection Investigations: A Scoping Review. Society for Social Work and Research (SSWR) Annual Conference. *Phoenix, AZ*.

McNellan, C.R.*, Palmer, L., Putnam-Hornstein, E., McCroskey, J. Risk, Race, and Community-Based Service Referrals in Los Angeles County, California. Society for Social Work and Research (SSWR) Annual Conference. *Phoenix, AZ*.

Putnam-Hornstein, E.*, Vaithianathan, R., Cuccaro-Alamin, S., McCroskey, J., Ahn, E.,
McNellan, C.R. Developing and Implementing a Predictive Risk Model to Support Child Protection Supervisors: Results from Los Angeles County Risk Stratification Pilot. Society for Social Work and Research (SSWR) Annual Conference. *Phoenix, AZ*.

2022

McNellan, C.R.*, Eastman, A., Prindle, J., Putnam-Hornstein, E. Mortality During Transitions Out of Foster Care: Evidence from California. Population Association of America (PAA) Annual Meeting. *Atlanta, GA* (presented remotely due to COVID-19).

McNellan, C.R.*, Eastman, A., Prindle, J., Foust, R., Herd, T. Leveraging Linked, Administrative Data to Inform Policy and Practice for Adolescents who have Child Protective Services (CPS) Involvement. The International Society for the Prevention of Child Abuse & Neglect (ISPCAN) International Congress. *Tallinn, Estonia* (withdrawn due to COVID-19).

McNellan, C.R.*, Prindle, J., Putnam-Hornstein, E., Cuccaro-Alamin, S., Palmer, L. Risk Assessment Tools to Support Child Welfare Practice. The International Society for the Prevention of Child Abuse & Neglect (ISPCAN) International Congress. *Tallinn, Estonia* (withdrawn due to COVID-19).

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McNellan, C.R.*, Palmer, L., Putnam-Hornstein, E., McCroskey, J. Assessing the Utility of a Predictive Risk Model to Increase Service Connections in Los Angeles, California. The International Society for the Prevention of Child Abuse & Neglect (ISPCAN) International Congress. *Quebec City, Quebec* (withdrawn due to COVID-19).

Prindle, J.*, Foust, R., **McNellan, C.R.**, Putnam-Hornstein, E. Modeling Academic Achievement Among Maltreated Children: Implications for Policy. Annual Association for Public Policy Analysis & Management (APPAM) Conference. *Austin, TX*.

McNellan, C.R.*, Palmer, L., McCroskey, J., Putnam-Hornstein, E. Using a Predictive Risk Model to Assess Racial Disparities in Service Referrals Following a Child Protection Investigation. Society for Social Work and Research (SSWR) Annual Conference. *Washington, DC*. (withdrawn due to COVID-19).

2021

Prindle, J., Eastman, A.L., **McNellan, C.R.**, Putnam-Hornstein, E. Cohort Study of Mortality Among Youth in Foster Care. Society for Social Work and Research (SSWR) Annual Conference. *Virtual*. (withdrawn due to COVID-19).

Gibbs, D., **McNellan, C.R.** The Empirical Evidence for Child Participation in Dependency Court Proceedings: Results of a Systematic Review of the Literature. National Association of Counsel for Children (NACC) Child Welfare Law Conference. *Denver, CO*. (withdrawn due to COVID-19).

2017

McNellan, C.R. (Poster) Uptake of Antenatal Care and its Relationship with Participation in Health Services and Behaviors: An Analysis of the Poorest Regions of Four Mesoamerican Countries. The Consortium of Universities for Global Health Annual Conference. *Washington, DC*.

INVITED TALKS

2024

McNellan, C.R. Mortality in a California Cohort of Adolescents and Young Adults Exiting Foster Care. HSMP 7010: Foundations in Health Services Research, Department of Health Systems, Management & Policy, University of Colorado Anschutz Medical Campus.

McNellan, C.R., Putnam-Hornstein, E. Mortality Outcomes for Young Adults Transitioning from Foster Care. California's Workgroup on Suicide and Overdose Prevention.

2023

McNellan, C.R. Learning Loss during the COVID-19 Pandemic. Children's Data Network Brown Bag.

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TEACHING

2024 (Spring), 2023 (Fall)

Doctoral Professional Development Seminar

(Teaching Assistant)

Doctoral seminar: my lectures covered best practices in data management and I offered statistics office hours.

2022 (Fall)

Social Work Practice with Organizations and Communities

(Mentored Second Instructor)

Graduate course covering: theoretical foundations of “macro” practice, including critical theories and systems theories; data interpretation and analysis; local, state, and national policy; intervention planning; community-based needs assessments.

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Peer Reviewer

Child Maltreatment (2022)

Reproductive Health (2021, 2022)

BMJ Open (2020)

Member

Population Association of America

Society for Social Work and Research

International Society for the Prevention of Child Abuse and Neglect

ACADEMIC MENTORING

Dissertation Committee, R.M., 2024-

UNIVERSITY SERVICE

2023-2024 **Doctoral Candidate Representative**

2020-2022 **Doctoral Student Representative**

Doctoral Program Committee

University of North Carolina School of Social Work

2022-2024 **Chair**

2020-2022 **Member**

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Child Maltreatment Research and Practice Network
University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill Injury Prevention Research Center

PROFESSIONAL POSITIONS & AFFILIATIONS

2024-	University of Colorado Injury and Violence Prevention Center Faculty Member, Aurora, CO
2024-	Learning Community on Family Economic Well-Being Research Member, Colorado Evaluation and Action Lab, Denver, CO
2020-	Children's Data Network Research Affiliate, Los Angeles, CA & Chapel Hill, NC
2024	Office of Children, Youth and Families' Colorado Implementation Science Unit Research Coordinator, Denver, CO
2020	Global Center for Integrated Health of Women, Adolescents, & Children Research Scientist, Seattle, WA
2018-2019	National Court Appointed Special Advocates (CASA)/Guardians ad Litem (GAL) Association for Children Associate Director of Data Analysis & Governance, Seattle, WA
2017-2018	National CASA/GAL Association for Children Data Governance & Evaluation Specialist, Seattle, WA
2016	Public Health Foundation of India Visiting Research Fellow, Gurgaon, India
2014-2017	Institute for Health Metrics and Evaluation Post-Bachelor Fellow, Seattle, WA
2014	Western Organization for People Living with HIV/AIDS & GlobeMed Intern, Mumias, Kenya
2012	Melghat Maitri Intern, Chilati, India

SELECTED TRAININGS

2024	<i>The Road To Equity: Children's Bureau 2024 Race Equity Challenge</i> The Children's Bureau
2022	<i>Interdisciplinary Research Institute: Challenges in Child Maltreatment Research</i> The Kempe Center for the Prevention and Treatment of Child Abuse and Neglect
2020	<i>Data Matters: Intro. to Big Data and Machine Learning for Social Scientists</i> University of North Carolina Odum Institute for Research in Social Science
2019	<i>Interdisciplinary Research Institute: Challenges & Opportunities in Child Maltreatment Research</i> The Kempe Center for the Prevention and Treatment of Child Abuse and Neglect
2018	<i>Court Appointed Special Advocate (CASA) Training</i> National Court Appointed Special Advocates (CASA) /Guardians ad Litem (GAL) Association for Children